



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Holy Family Academy
School Website: <https://hfamn.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Holy Family Academy Mn 55416 (HFAMN) presents a robust Catholic classical-leaning program that intertwines Montessori beginnings with a traditional Trivium-inspired curriculum. Public-facing materials emphasize virtue formation, spiritual development, liturgical life, and a Great-Books oriented pedagogy, anchored in Catholic theology and liturgy. The school explicitly frames its mission around forming body, soul, and mind, with a stated ultimate goal of salvation in Jesus Christ. Taken together with Montessori roots and a clearly stated classical curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin; great books; history), HFAMN demonstrates substantial alignment with classical education values, though some aspects of pedagogy and faculty articulation remain less explicit in the public materials. Overall, HFAMN is best characterized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with strong Classical cues, particularly in curriculum and religious foundations, and with room to more fully document some classical-fidelity elements in pedagogy and faculty articulation.

Key observations driving the overall rating - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: The school is explicitly Catholic, integrates liturgy and calendar life, and emphasizes truth, goodness, and beauty as intelligible and knowable ideals. The liturgical life (Mass; liturgical calendar) and Catholic formation pervade the public materials. Evidence includes explicit statements about Catholic identity, spiritual formation, and the Incarnation framework.

- Purpose and Goal: The program centers formation, virtue, wisdom, and human flourishing, with a Catholic telos and a clear emphasis on moral and intellectual formation rather than mere information. The materials repeatedly tie education to virtue and the transcendent aims of Catholic formation. - Curriculum: The Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin, Great Books, history, and a strong historical/cultural frame are explicit parts of the curriculum. The Great-Books orientation and Trivium framing are well documented on HFAMN materials. - Pedagogy: Public materials emphasize memorization, recitation, language development, and liturgical integration as core practices; some evidence of discursive/Socratic elements appears less explicit in K–8 materials. The presence of memorization, recitation, and ritual life is clear, with less explicit documentation of Socratic seminars in upper grades. - Faculty: Public statements highlight capable, faith-aligned teaching, with parent quotes praising teacher expertise and the integration of faith, academics, and moral development; however, explicit "living curriculum" portrayals or detailed faculty-formation language are not strongly evident in the public materials. - Parents & Community: The school emphasizes partnership with parents, parent formation activities, frequent events, and open campus-style enrollment for family engagement, including Parent Enrichment Night and Catholic School Week activities. This indicates a strong classical-community orientation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Clear Catholic identification and mission (Catholic classical curriculum; emphasis on spiritual formation; Incarnation language). - Liturgical life documented (liturgical calendar; Mass; liturgy references). - Theological framing around truth, goodness, and beauty in Catholic context (truth/goodness/beauty; salvation in Jesus Christ).

- Montessori + Catholic classical synthesis reflects a transcendental, sacred frame for education (Incarnation, sacredness of truth/beauty).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology (Catholic theological framing); liturgy, Mass; liturgical calendar; sacred/Incarnation language; Catholic heritage. Recurrent phrases explicitly connect education to transcendent ideals and sacred life.

- Negative keywords: None evident in the public materials.

Why this rating - HFAMN's public materials consistently articulate a Catholic metaphysical orientation, with explicit references to truth/goodness/beauty, liturgical life, and theological framing. The strong presence of liturgical life and Catholic formation aligns with the Classical/Religious Foundations quadrant in the Six Elements lexicon. This category receives CLASSICAL because reverence for transcendentals and liturgical practice anchors the education in a clearly theological frame.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit emphasis on formation and virtue; development of body, soul, and mind; formation in Catholic faith; goal aligned with catechesis and spiritual formation. - Language around truth, goodness, and beauty as the telos of education; the aim of human formation rather than mere information. - References to virtue, wisdom, and the Catholic telos (salvation in Jesus Christ) as central aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, scholé/contemplation (where present in the lexicon and aligned with HFAMN's aims). - Negative keywords: None evident in HFAMN's public materials.

Why this rating - HFAMN's stated purpose focuses on virtue formation, wisdom, and a transcendent telos consistent with classical paideia ideals, including a stated emphasis on contemplation and the true/good/beautiful. This aligns with CLASSICAL indicators for Element 2.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit mention of the liberal arts framework via the Trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric. - Study of Latin; emphasis on great stories and great books; systematic historical study across epochs; integration with math, language arts, and thinking skills. - History integrated throughout the curriculum (history among core subjects) and a robust Great Books orientation; Montessorian foundation with classical core.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: grammar, logic, rhetoric; great books; Latin; history; Western civilization (implied by "major historical epochs"); primary sources; classics; recitation; narration. - Negative keywords: None evident in HFAMN's public materials (no primacy of social studies terminology replacing history; no project-based-first framing described in public text). The lexicon's negative indicators are not observed in HFAMN's content.

Why this rating - The curriculum embodies core classical elements: the Trivium, Great Books, Latin, and a historical/Western civ orientation, with a clear emphasis on memory-based learning and recitation. These align with CLASSICAL curricular indicators. HFAMN's Montessori integration complements but does not replace these classical curricularly-significant aims.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Recitation, memorization, and language-based memory work are explicitly described as central in the grammar stage; the school emphasizes story-led and language-rich learning in early grades. - Lower grades involve singing and memory-related activities as part of forming memory and delight in learning, and upper grades emphasize logic and rhetoric as part of the education pathway. - The school references the Trivium's logic stage and a structured progression through different classical stages.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: recitation; memory; chanting/singing (as described in the lexicon's pedagogy list and supported by the school's memory-focused approach);

scholé/restful learning (supported by classical pedagogy; explicit restful/ contemplative elements are less directly documented in HFAMN's public text, though liturgical rhythm and spiritual formation imply a contemplative cadence). - Negative keywords: The public materials do not emphasize project-based learning or experiential-learning-only approaches; however, the explicit articulation of Socratic seminars or upper-level rhetorical seminars is not strongly documented. This reduces the category's alignment with a fully Socratic model.

Why this rating - HFAMN shows many core pedagogical practices associated with classical education (recitation, memory work, grammar/logic/rhetoric progression, liturgical rhythm), but it does not publicly document a full 9–12 Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy or an explicit emphasis on progressive, project-based reform that some classical schools avoid. Therefore, a CERTAINLY classical core is present, but the pedagogy lacks complete explicitness in some Socratic/seminar elements; hence, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe teachers as capable and dedicated to integrating faith, academics, and moral development; parent quotes emphasize teachers' expertise. - The Montessorian and classical framing implies teacher role as a mentor and facilitator of a faith-informed education; one text notes that Holy Family Academy has "teachers' expertise and helpfulness" in aiding student transitions. - There is less explicit language about a formal "living curriculum" or a defined teacher portrait or a formal teacher-formation program in the public materials, which keeps this category from reaching a full Classical articulation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: model teachers and mentors (implied by integration of faith/academics; "teacher expertise"); collegial atmosphere; faith-informed formation; living curriculum (not explicitly stated, but implied by the combination of Montessori and classical orientation). - Negative keywords: The explicit lexicon's "living curriculum" portrait and other formal faculty-culture descriptors are not overtly documented; thus, this category lacks strong documentation of fully realized classical-faculty attributes.

Why this rating - The school presents capable, faith-aligned teaching and a strong teacher presence through testimonials and program descriptions, but lacks explicit, published language on a formal "living curriculum" portrayal or comprehensive classical-faculty profile. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize partnerships with parents and co-teacher-like involvement; parent formation activities and classical book group opportunities are described (Parent Enrichment Night; Catholic Schools Week; family liturgy alignment).

- Open campus and parent involvement language is present; families are encouraged to tour and engage with the school's mission. The Welcome materials and parent testimonials further support family engagement as a core element.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parent formation; reading groups; seminars; classical book clubs; open campus/hospitality; family liturgy; parental participation. - Negative keywords: None evident; the materials depict active parent involvement rather than consumer/customer-only framing.

Why this rating - HFAMN shows robust parent/community integration, including enrichment events and a culture of parental involvement in formation and school life, aligning well with Classical expectations for Parents & Community. This category earns CLASSICAL.

Aggregate assessment - Element 1: CLASSICAL - Element 2: CLASSICAL - Element 3: CLASSICAL - Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What would move the needle

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- Strengthen explicit articulation of a full Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy for upper grades (including documented examples of seminars, debates, or Paideia-style discussions) to upgrade Element 4 from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL.
 - Develop and publish a formal “living curriculum” description for faculty (Element 5) that outlines teacher portrait, professional formation in classical pedagogy, and ongoing teacher mentorship aligned with the classical tradition.
 - More explicit Great Conversation language and integration into the curriculum (Element 3) to emphasize ongoing engagement with Great Books and the Great Conversation across grade levels, not just in scattered references.
 - Expand visible documentation of faculty-student mentorship and teacher-as-mentor narratives to reinforce the “living curriculum” perception (Element 5).
 - Continue and broaden parent formation initiatives and public-facing evidence of parent partnerships (Element 6), including more structured parent-teacher co-learning experiences and family-facing liturgical life.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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